

SINETHEMBA MVELASE

Junior Quantitative Analyst | Risk Analytics | Data & Model Support

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Talent Acquisition Team

Group Risk Quant Team

Old Mutual South Africa

| Application: Junior Quantitative Analyst — Group Risk Quant Team

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the **Junior Quantitative Analyst** position within the **Group Risk Quant Team at Old Mutual South Africa**. I hold a **BSc in Mathematics and Physics** from the University of Johannesburg (probability, statistics, linear algebra, mathematical modelling) and am currently a **Discover Graduate Trainee at Vodacom Financial Services**, delivering analytics and reporting directly into Risk Management, Technology Assurance, and executive committees. I believe the combination of that mathematical foundation, applied financial services exposure, and a genuine curiosity for quantitative risk makes me a strong fit for your team.

In my current role I work daily with the exact building blocks the Group Risk Quant Team relies on: **extracting data with SQL, cleaning and transforming it in Python and Excel, tracking KPIs, reconciling metrics, and translating results into dashboards and executive reports**. I have supported **AWS Cost Optimization** analyses, contributed to governance reporting for Steering and Management Committees, and automated recurring reporting workflows — all of which are directly transferable to **model development support, model validation, model risk oversight, and data quality management**.

I have also built a quantitative model of my own. In the **KasiKash** project I designed **KasiScore**, an **alternative credit-scoring engine** for township SMEs built on transaction volume, frequency, repayment behaviour, and stokvel contribution patterns. Constructing it end-to-end — feature engineering, model evaluation, and productionisation on PostgreSQL/Supabase — gave me practical, first-hand exposure to the credit-risk modelling workflow that quantitative teams inside banks and insurers rely on. On a cross-border engagement with **Vodafone Portugal**, I extended those skills to enterprise scale using **Google BigQuery, GCP, and Vertex AI** for EDA, feature preparation, and modelling.

Old Mutual's leadership in South African financial services, and the Group Risk Quant Team's role in shaping how the group measures, models, and governs risk, is exactly the environment in which I want to build my career. I am eager to contribute to quantitative analytics, dashboarding, and model support work — and to keep building depth in SQL, Python, Tableau, and Alteryx alongside a strong quant team. I have attached my CV and would welcome the chance to discuss how I can contribute.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Kind regards,

Sinethemba Mvelase

Attached: CV (Sinethemba_Mvelase_CV_Quant.pdf)